Illustrative walkthrough. The company, brief, students and scores are invented examples. Payments are simulated.

01 / CHALLENGE FROM AN EXAMPLE DATA COMPANY

Flag faulty sensor readings before they reach the dashboard

Northwind Analytics (illustrative SaaS company) streams temperature readings from 2,000 warehouse sensors. Some sensors drift or freeze. Build a check that flags bad readings and explain your approach to their engineering team.

What you deliver

- A script or notebook that labels each reading as OK, drifting or frozen
- Results on the provided 7-day sample (CSV, 140,000 rows)
- A one-page README: approach, trade-offs, what you would do next
- For teams: a task list or commit history showing who did what

How it is scored

Rubric criterion	Weight
Detection quality on hidden test readings (automated)	35%
Code clarity and structure	20%
Reasoning and trade-offs in the README	20%
Handling of edge cases (gaps, duplicates, time zones)	15%
Communication: could the team ship this?	10%

Rubric signed off by a Northwind data engineer. Automated tests and an AI rubric score every submission (labelled AI-assisted); the engineer scores a sample that includes lower-ranked entries and writes the feedback on every certified result.

TIME BOX

4 hours

Format	**Solo or team of up to 3**
Open until	**30 October 2026**
Entry	**Free**
Certified result	**€15, optional**

Sized for students with 2–7 hours a week, the range most survey respondents reported.

Why a real brief matters: students said the hardest part of applying is showing work beyond coursework and

explaining their own part in it.

02 / TEAM "DRIFTWATCH" SUBMITS

Every member's contribution is on the record

SkillBridge reads the team's commit history and task list, then each member confirms the split. Disagreements go to the reviewer before any certificate is issued.

Student A · drift detection model **45%**

14 commits · detector.py, tests/test_drift.py · confirmed by B and C

Student B · data cleaning and edge cases **35%**

9 commits · clean.py, gaps and time-zone handling · confirmed by A and C

Student C · README and results summary **20%**

4 commits · README.md, results chart · confirmed by A and B

Shares come from what each person built, not commit counts alone. A member can dispute their share before submission closes.

SUBMISSION

Submitted **3 h 40 min after start**

Automated tests

Passed 41 of 44

Contribution split

Confirmed by all 3

Recruiters keep asking students "what did *you* do?". This page is the answer.

82 / 100 against Northwind's rubric

Top 15% of 48 submissions. Your result is private until you choose to share it.

Criterion	AI rubric	Engineer
Detection quality (35)	31	31
Code clarity (20)	16	15
Reasoning (20)	17	17
Edge cases (15)	10	11
Communication (10)	8	8
Total	**82**	**82**

Feedback from the Northwind engineer

"The frozen-sensor check is exactly what we use in production. The drift threshold is fixed; we would make it per-sensor. Clear README, I could hand this to a teammate tomorrow."

YOUR SCORE IS FREE TO KEEP

Certify it to get the rubric breakdown, written feedback from the Northwind engineer, your verified contribution and a shareable link for your CV. The certificate always shows your true score.

€15

This button is the test: in the pilot, real students choose whether to pay after seeing their score.

Student A's SkillBridge profile

Each certified challenge stacks on the profile. A recruiter can open any result to see the brief, the rubric and exactly what this student did.

CERTIFIED CHALLENGE RESULT

Flag faulty sensor readings · Northwind Analytics

82 / 100 · top 15% of 48

Personal contribution	**45% · drift detection model**
Reviewed by	**Northwind data engineer**
Date	**30 October 2026**

Verify at skillbridge.example/c/7Q2-K9 (illustrative link)

STACKED RESULTS

Sensor data quality · Northwind (data)	**82**
Rate-limited API client · example SaaS (backend)	**74**
Accessible sign-up form · example SaaS (frontend)	**88**

Skills shown: Python, pandas, testing, API design, accessibility.

Still unproven: whether recruiters trust this score enough to shortlist on it, and whether students pay to certify. Both are tested in the experiment card.